



PARISH NEWSLETTER

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Fr Micheál McGavigan PP – Fr Roni Zacharias CC – Fr Stephen Ward CC

Sunday 16th August 2026 – Twentieth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A

The Gospel for this Sunday recounts Jesus' encounter with a Canaanite woman whose daughter is tormented by a demon (Matthew 15:21-28). Initially, Jesus appears dismissive, stating that He was sent only to the lost sheep of Israel and even comparing her to a dog unworthy of the children's bread. Yet, the woman persists, humbly acknowledging her need and demonstrating remarkable faith. Her courage and persistence lead Jesus to commend her faith and heal her daughter.

This passage challenges us to reflect on faith and humility. True faith is not about pretending to be strong; it is about admitting our need for God and asking for help, even when answers seem delayed or social barriers make it difficult. The woman's example teaches that persistence in prayer and trust in God's mercy can overcome obstacles and bring about transformation, both for ourselves and others.

WELCOME TO GOD'S FAMILY

Méabh Eileen McGlinchey; Lana McCready;
Reuben John Cruickshank-McCloskey; Callum Patrick O'Neill;
Luca Pearse O'Doherty; Shane Duddy; Shea William Curran;
Rúa Maeve McGeady; Darragh Christian McGeady;

REQUIESCANT IN PACE

We offer our sympathies to the family and friends of:
John Coyle, Glen Road; Sarah (Ellen) Kelly, Leafair Park;
Lenny Cooper, Fortwilliam Terrace;
Frank Downey, Messines Park.

ANNIVERSARIES

Malachy Bradley; Hugh D'Arcy; Tommy Mullany;
Kathleen Coyle; Michael Farren Jnr; Andy Barr; Brendan Gillen;
Mary Grant; Gerard McKinney; Neil Doran; Kathleen Dunne;
Lee Brinkley; Bridget Halford; Bridie Doherty; Charlie Large;
Rosie O'Doherty.

STILL YOUNG AT HEART

My deepest gratitude and appreciation go to parishioners who acknowledged my recent 'significant birthday' in a variety of ways. Your thoughtfulness and kindness are greatly appreciated. What was expected to be a quiet and little-known occasion turned out to be filled with sincere congratulations and best wishes which have filled me with joy and touched me in a way which will never be forgotten. Many thanks for the memories. *Fr Peter.*

READINGS FOR SUNDAY 23rd AUGUST

1st Isaiah 22:19-23. Psalm: 137: 1-3, 6, 8, R/v 8.
2nd Romans 11:33-36. Gospel Matthew 16:13-20.

SIMPLE FAMILY PRAYER BOOK

This Sunday begins psalter week 4.

PILGRIMAGE TO CYPRUS

The parish is considering a 7-night pilgrimage to Cyprus from 16–23 May 2027, following in the footsteps of St Paul and St Barnabas. The pilgrimage would include visits to many of Cyprus's most important Christian and historical sites, with the opportunity to celebrate Mass in places closely associated with the early Church.

The package includes direct flights from Belfast, full-board accommodation in a four-star seafront hotel, and a guided programme of pilgrimage visits throughout the week. The estimated cost is £1,675 per person. At this stage, we are simply seeking expressions of interest. If you think you may wish to join the pilgrimage, please contact the parish office. Registering your interest is not a commitment to travel.

VOCATIONS

That the men called to priesthood will "...
have a care for justice [and] act with integrity..."
as they preach the message of God's salvation for everyone,
the Good News that the Church is "...
a house of prayer for all the peoples."

LAST WEEK'S OFFERTORY COLLECTION

St Patrick's Church: £1,388 - St Brigid's Church: £2,097 - St Joseph's Church: £990
2nd Collection (Maintenance & Pastoral Outreach): £1,047.

Thank you for your continued generosity.

BANK DETAILS FOR ONLINE DONATIONS: A/C Name: The Parish of the Three Patrons
Sort Code: 95-06-79 A/C No: 60320021

JOB OPPORTUNITY, DERRY DIOCESAN TRUST:

Administrative & Financial Officer (18 hours per week), Waterside Parish, Parochial House, 32 Chapel Road, Derry. Rate of pay: £12.88 per hr - £13.50 per hour. For an application pack please email: recruitment@derrydiocese.org or tel 028 7126 2302.

Completed applications must be returned to Personnel, Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Francis Street, Derry, BT48 9AP or via email to recruitment@derrydiocese.org no later than 12 noon Monday 24 August 2026.

Derry Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer. We welcome applications from all men and women and from members of all communities.

THE CHURCHES TRUST

We are currently recruiting for our Community Support Service based in the city. This service provides much needed befriending for elderly living independently at home. Flexible Part-Time Work as a Personal Assistant - We're looking for caring, reliable individuals to join our panel of self-employed personal assistants. Set your own hours. Earn extra income

Make a difference in your community. No experience required, we provide training and support. Applicants should have full, clean driving license and access to a vehicle. Apply today and start helping those in need, call 028 71311322 for more information.

MARRIAGE ENRICHMENT WEEKEND

Marriage Encounter Ireland invites married couples to a residential Weekend from Friday 2 to Sunday 4 October 2026 at the Focolare Centre, Curryhills, Prosperous, Co. Kildare. Step away from daily distractions to deepen your communication, renew your love, and rediscover the joy of your marriage. Visit www.marriageencounter.ie

ROSARY ON THE COAST

Today, Sunday 16th August in Benone Beach. All welcome.

'EMBRACE THE GRACE'

Young Adult Catholic Conference - 29 August 2026 - a conference on faith and culture for young adults (18-40) with talks, prayer, Mass, confession, workshops, food and social in the historic Legion of Mary headquarters at De Montfort House, North Brunswick Street, Dublin 7. It will be a chance to build faith in friendship with young adults from across the country. Saturday 30 August from 9.30am to 6pm with a social afterwards. Tickets €20 and can be booked on the eventbrite website by looking up 'Embrace the Grace'. Further queries contact: deusetpatria@gmail.com

THE NATIONAL NOVENA TO OUR LADY OF KNOCK

Takes place at Knock Shrine from Thursday 13 to Friday 21 August 2026. Novena ceremonies will be celebrated daily at 3pm and 8pm, with workshops and guided prayer sessions also taking place throughout the nine days. This year's theme is "Sheltered in God's Love." Everyone is very welcome.

See the full programme at: <https://www.knockshrine.ie/national-novena-2026-guest-speakers-and-programme/>

ST PIO CAFÉ

The Café at St Pio house will be closed for the next few weeks and will reopen on Tuesday 2nd September. We thank all those who help to make this such a success.

PRIVACY NOTICE

Is available on the parish website: threepatrons.org

SAFEGUARDING

If you have any concerns about the Safeguarding of Children or vulnerable adults within the Church, please contact Marie O'Kane, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596500793 or at dlp@derrydiocese.org

PARISH GROUPS & MEETINGS (SUMMER)

Monday	After 11am Mass 1pm – 2.30pm 7pm - 9pm	Holy Souls Prayer Group Legion of Mary Woman's Craft Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh Meeting Room, St Joseph's Church, Galliagh Kildare Room, Carnhill
Tuesday	After 11am Mass 11.30am - 2.30pm 7.30pm - 9.30pm	Devotion to the Holy Face St. Pio's Café Living Disciples Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh St Pio Centre, Galliagh (Closed until September) St Pio Centre, Galliagh
Thursday	11.30am - 2.30pm 6pm – 7pm 7pm – 8pm 7.30pm - 8.30pm 8.15pm – 10pm	St. Pio's Café Divine Will Prayer Group Holy Hour for the Unborn Youth Prayer Group Be Still – Men's Prayer Group	St. Pio Centre, Galliagh (Closed until September) Kildare Room, Carnhill Our Lady's Chapel St. Pio Centre, Galliagh Our Lady's Chapel
Friday	11.30am-12.30pm	Divine Mercy Prayer Group	Our Lady's Chapel, Galliagh

PARISH SCHEDULE - SUMMER**ST PATRICK'S CHURCH, PENNYBURN**

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 6.15pm; 9.45am
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 10am
Confessions:	Saturday: 5.15pm – 6pm
Baptisms:	Saturday: 4.30pm; Sunday: 1.30pm

ST BRIGID'S CHURCH, CARNHILL

Sunday Mass:	Vigil 5pm; 10.30am & 12.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 9.30am; Saturday: 11am
Confessions:	Saturday after 11.00am Mass and 4pm - 4.45pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Daily: 8.00am – 8.00pm in St Carlo Acutis Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm

ST JOSEPH'S CHURCH, GALLIAGH

Sunday Mass:	11.00am; 12.30pm (<i>An tAifreann Naofa</i>); 6.30pm
Weekday Mass:	Monday to Friday: 11am
Confessions:	Sunday: 5.30pm – 6.15pm
Eucharistic Adoration:	Tuesday: 11.30am – 1pm in Our Lady's Chapel
Baptisms:	Saturday: 3.30pm